

# Master vs. Sync vs. Neighboring Rights

Three rights in one song - and who gets paid for each.

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## WHY THIS MATTERS

A single song contains multiple rights. In highlight reels, event content, and social video, schools and creators routinely need more than one permission. This reference untangles the three most common rights so the next clearance question is clear.

## WHAT'S INSIDE

- Master: the actual sound recording and who owns that file
- Sync: the right to pair music with moving images - required for any video using a song
- Neighboring rights: performance-side royalties tied to the recording, adjacent to copyright
- Highlight reels usually need both master and sync clearance; buying the song does not grant sync rights
- When in doubt, treat unlicensed music in video as a clearance question, not a taste question

## ABOUT JAYLEN SINEGAL

Jaylen Sinegal is an executive brand strategist and media IP consultant in Louisiana. He teaches athlete and family brand architecture, NIL and music licensing to schools, and media copyright and facility audits. He is Chief Brand Officer of FlightTime Athletics LLC and builds the Find a Producer director for Louisiana music.

## A STANDING PROMISE

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